

USER GUIDE

How Food Safety Horizon Scanning works

This platform continuously aggregates food safety recalls and alerts from 90+ regulatory agencies worldwide, verifies each record, and publishes it here. This guide explains what you're looking at and how to get the most out of it.

01 What this platform does

Food safety incidents (recalls, alerts, border rejections) are published separately by dozens of national regulators — the FDA, USDA FSIS, the EU's RASFF network, France's RappelConso, Canada's CFIA, the UK's FSA, and 50+ others — each with its own website, language, and format. This platform collects those notices automatically, normalizes them into a common structure (date, company, product, pathogen, severity, source link), and republishes them here as one continuously updated feed.

Every record links back to the original regulator notice, so anything you see here can be independently verified at the source.

02 Reading the live dashboard

The **Live Dashboard** is the main entry point. At the top, the KPI tiles summarize the current dataset:

TOTAL RECALLS IN DB

The full count of tracked incidents currently in the system.

TIER-1 CRITICAL

Incidents flagged as the highest severity — see the tier legend below.

Severity tiers — every incident is assigned a tier based on the regulator's own classification (e.g. FDA Class I/II/III) or, when that's not available, on the pathogen and product type:

TIER 1 • CRITICAL

TIER 2 • MAJOR

TIER 3 • MINOR

Tier 1 covers cases most likely to cause serious illness (e.g. *Listeria* in a ready-to-eat product, or any confirmed outbreak). Tier 2 covers moderate risk. Tier 3 covers lower-risk or precautionary notices.

Pathogen badges — the table's Pathogen column uses a color code so you can scan a page of results at a glance:

Listeria

Salmonella

E. coli / STEC

C. botulinum

Norovirus

Aflatoxin

Cereulide / *B. cereus*

Other

Filtering and sorting — use the search box and dropdown filters above the table to narrow by keyword, source, or tier. Click any column header to sort by it. The red pulsing dot next to a headline in the top ticker marks an active, ongoing incident.

03 The other views

- **Weekly** — a narrative briefing published each week, summarizing the period's incidents with process-engineering interpretation (thermal processing, HACCP control points) rather than just a raw list.
- **Monthly + AI** — a browsable archive of monthly briefings, each with trend charts and a written analysis of the month's activity.
- **Alerts** — subscribe to receive an email whenever a new incident matches criteria you choose (pathogen, product, country, or brand).
- **JSON Feed** (footer link) — the same dataset behind this dashboard, as raw JSON, for anyone who wants to build on top of it directly.

04 Data reliability

Every record carries the original regulator's source URL. New records go through an automated verification pass before publication, and a per-record audit trail tracks every automated correction. If you ever find a record that looks wrong, the source link is the fastest way to check it against the original notice.

05 Frequently asked questions

How often is the dashboard updated?

New scraping runs happen several times a day; the dashboard header shows the exact timestamp of the last update.

Why do some records have less detail than others?

Regulators publish in different formats and levels of detail. Where a field can't be reliably determined, it's left blank rather than guessed.

Can I get alerted about a specific country or product?

Custom alert subscriptions are temporarily unavailable. In the meantime, email info@visipilot.com with your criteria and we'll follow up.

Is the underlying data available in French?

Product and company names appear in their original language when the source regulator publishes in that language (for example, French records from RappelConso). A fully translated French interface is available: switch to FR using the toggle at the top right.

Questions not covered here? Every page links back to [index.html](#) — start from the live dashboard and the source link on any record for the full detail.